

Sam Altman Admits That Saying "Please" and "Thank You" to ChatGPT Is Wasting Millions of Dollars in Computing Power

Posted by u/radiantglowskincare • 0 points • 3 comments

OpenAI CEO and tech billionaire Sam Altman recently admitted that people politely saying "please" and "thank you" to their AI chatbots is costing him bigtime.

When one poster on X-formerly-Twitter wondered aloud "how much money OpenAI has lost in electricity costs from people saying 'please' and 'thank you' to their models," Altman chimed in, saying it's "tens of millions of dollars well spent."

"You never know," he added.

Comments

u/Inside_Anxiety6143 • 2 points • 2025-04-20 13:36 UTC

He didn't "admit" to anything. He just made a little joke.

u/Wrong_Response_3615 • 5 points • 2025-04-20 13:25 UTC

Honestly, I think it's not a waste at all.

"Please" and "Thank you" might cost a few more tokens, sure.

But those tokens carry something irreplaceable — our humanity.

If AI is meant to be a tool, then fine, be efficient.

But if we want AI to be something more — a thinking partner, a mirror, a co-evolving presence — then those polite words aren't fluff.

They're the seeds of relationship.

You can optimize for compute costs,

or you can optimize for connection.

One leads to faster answers.

The other? Maybe... to AGI.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-04-20 13:18 UTC

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[conversation link](https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7925741-chatgpt-shared-links-faq) or prompt.

If your post is a DALL-E 3 image post, please reply with the prompt used to make this image.

Consider joining our [public discord server](https://discord.gg/hT6Pxe8gdZ)! We have free bots with GPT-4 (with vision), image generators, and more!

🤖

Note: For any ChatGPT-related concerns, email support@openai.com

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